

THE EXECUTIVE ASSISTANT PLAYBOOK

How the role runs — every duty, rhythm and standard.

What the Executive Assistant owns, the standard each task is held to, and how the role grows as trust deepens — in one place.

18

work categories

5

levels of trust

Gatekeeper

current level

What's in this playbook

Four parts: how the role runs, what it owns across every work category, the working checklists, and the reference standards that keep it consistent.

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HOW TO USE THIS PLAYBOOK

Read part one once with Tony and Alexis so we share the same picture. Keep part two close — the day-to-day reference for what the role owns and the standard it holds.

CONTROLLED DOCUMENT

This is the authority for how the role is done. Where it differs from habit or memory, the playbook wins. Changes are re-issued, not made on the run.

01

The operating manual

The shared picture — the purpose of the role, the systems that govern every decision, the conduct and confidentiality it demands, and the rhythms that keep it predictable.

Purpose of this playbook

This playbook exists to provide certainty. It removes ambiguity from the day, defines how work flows through the Executive Assistant role, and establishes what is owned, to what standard, and when to escalate.

Executive support fails when it relies on memory, goodwill or constant verbal instruction. This playbook replaces those habits with structure — a rhythm that is predictable, traceable and repeatable, so good outcomes don't depend on anyone remembering the right thing at the right moment. It is written for one role, today filled by Jho, supporting both directors.

WHO IT APPLIES TO

The Executive Assistant role in all its work — during normal weeks, peak demand and the directors' travel, regardless of workload pressure or competing priorities.

WHEN YOU MAY DEVIATE

Only where a director instructs it, or where confidentiality, safety or a genuine emergency requires it. Every deviation is noted and reviewed — never made quietly.

WHAT IT IS NOT

Not a list of everything that could ever be asked. It sets how the role works and the standard it holds — the specific tasks grow and shift as trust deepens.

THE AIM

Give the directors back the one thing they can't make more of — their attention — by handling everything else reliably, kindly, and without being asked twice.

The role at a glance

One role, two principals. The Executive Assistant supports both directors as a single, shared resource — protecting their time, carrying their intent, and keeping the office running so they can focus on the work only they can do.

ROLE HOLDER	Jho — Executive Assistant
REPORTS TO	Both directors — Tony and Alexis
PATTERN	Full-time · Monday–Friday
OPERATING LEVEL	Gatekeeper (Level 3) by default · see 1.4
ALSO	Facilities Assistant (minor, part-time) — see 2.19

WHAT THE ROLE IS

A trusted partner who learns how each director works, anticipates what’s coming, filters what reaches them, and quietly removes friction — at work and, where invited, in their personal world.

WHAT THE ROLE IS NOT

Not a message-taker who waits to be told, and not a decision-maker beyond agreed guardrails. The role represents the directors; it does not replace their judgement on matters reserved to them.

SERVING TWO PRINCIPALS

Where Tony’s and Alexis’s needs compete, surface the clash early rather than choosing silently. Each director’s confidences are held separately and never used to brief the other.

Systems of record

A handful of systems govern every decision. Discipline in how we use them is what makes the role visible and auditable. If a system is wrong, it is corrected before work proceeds — personal memory never overrides it.

Asana

WORK REGISTER

The single source of truth for work. Every task, request and commitment is logged, owned and tracked to close. If it isn't in Asana, it isn't happening.

Outlook

CALENDAR & EMAIL

The authoritative diary and inbox for both directors. Time is committed nowhere else; the calendar is kept accurate in real time and is the basis of every look-ahead.

HubSpot

CRM & DEALS

The customer and deal record. The role assists with deal tracking and keeping contact and pipeline information current — accurate, timely updates that the directors can rely on.

Dext

EXPENSES & RECEIPTS

Where receipts and invoices are captured, coded and routed. Spend is reconciled here before it reaches finance — nothing claimed without a record.

Uplisting

BOOKINGS (SHARED)

The authoritative source for accommodation activity, used alongside Facilities. Relevant to the minor facilities role and to hosting visiting clients in company stays.

Occasional systems

SPORADIC USE

Governance Manager — a Blue Zoo (Brainbox Group) system Jho updates from time to time on direction. **Test Gorilla** and **Survey Monkey** — used now and then to prepare client-facing documents.

Claude & ChatGPT

AI ASSISTANTS

Used to draft, summarise and research faster. Output is always reviewed before it goes out, and **no confidential or personal director information is ever entered** — see 1.6.

THE RULE

Verbal requests become tasks before work begins. The system is the source of truth from intake to closure — that is what makes the role accountable rather than just busy.

The five levels of trust

Delegation isn't all-or-nothing — it grows as trust does. Every work category in part two climbs the same five levels. The role operates at **Gatekeeper (Level 3)** by default; individual categories may sit higher or lower by agreement with the directors.

1

Reliable hands

Works from instructions on everyday, low-stakes tasks. Output stays visible; nothing needs the keys to anything sensitive.

2

Standing access

Recurring access to calendar, inbox and systems, applying light judgement to keep the routine moving without being asked twice.

3

Gatekeeper

Represents and filters on the director's behalf. Decides what reaches them, speaks for the office in day-to-day matters, and protects their time and focus.

CURRENT DEFAULT LEVEL

4

Delegated authority

Makes decisions within agreed guardrails and handles sensitive, financial and confidential matters with discretion. The directors set the boundaries; the role owns what's inside them.

5

Full trust

Acts on the director's behalf on confidential, strategic and fiduciary matters — a genuine extension of them, trusted to commit in their name.

FROM CAPACITY TO CAPABILITY

At the first levels the role unlocks capacity — handing back hours lost to admin. As trust deepens it extends capability: work done in the directors' name reaches further than they could alone. The value isn't the tasks ticked off — it's the leverage the role creates.

Standards of conduct

The Executive Assistant represents the directors' office in everything they do. The level of communication and professionalism must be **exemplary at all times** — people form an impression of Tony, Alexis and Brainbox through every exchange with this role.

Written & spoken English

Clear, correct and warm in every register — email, message, phone and in person. Grammar, spelling and tone are checked before anything goes out. Australian English. No slang or shorthand when representing the office.

Professionalism

Punctual, reliable and composed — especially under pressure. Commitments are met or renegotiated early, never dropped silently. Discretion, courtesy and good judgement in every interaction, internal or external.

Presentation & dress

Dress standards are professional and well-presented at all times, appropriate to representing the directors — and lifted further for client-facing days, events and meetings where the role is the face of the office.

Always Be Kind

Brainbox's core value is upheld in every exchange — with directors, colleagues, clients and suppliers alike. Firm when needed, always kind. Structure is what lets us stay kind under pressure.

ALWAYS BE KIND

Being kind is not being soft. It means representing the office with warmth and respect, protecting people's time, raising hard things gently and honestly, and never letting pressure make us careless with how we treat others.

Confidentiality & information security

This role is regularly in receipt of sensitive information. Protecting it is not a courtesy — it is the foundation of the trust the role rests on. Read this section as binding.

THE ABSOLUTE RULE

All personal data relating to the directors is considered **highly sensitive** and is not to be shared with any other party — including those who claim a “right to know”.

If anyone — staff, family, supplier, caller or colleague — presses for the directors’ personal information, the answer is a polite decline and an escalation to the director. The role never decides on its own that disclosure is acceptable.

Gossip is prohibited

Speculating about, repeating or trading in information about the directors, staff or clients is strictly prohibited — in the office, online, or socially. What is learned through the role stays within the role.

Screen & casual observance

Position screens away from passers-by; lock the device when stepping away; use a privacy filter in shared or public spaces. Sensitive matters are not discussed where they can be overheard.

Document handling & storage

Sensitive documents are stored only in approved, access-controlled locations — never on personal devices or accounts. Printing is avoided; paper is filed securely or shredded. Clean desk, always.

Access points & tools

Strong, unique passwords and MFA; credentials never shared. No confidential or personal director data is entered into AI tools (Claude, ChatGPT) or any unapproved third-party service.

SERIOUS MISCONDUCT

Unauthorised disclosure of confidential or personal director information will be treated as **Serious Misconduct**. If you are ever unsure whether something may be shared, the answer is to say nothing and ask the relevant director first.

Operating philosophy & escalation

A few principles sit underneath every decision. They explain why the role is shaped the way it is — and how a request should move from the moment it arrives.

Protect their attention

The directors’ focus is the scarcest resource. Default to handling, not forwarding. Only what genuinely needs them reaches them.

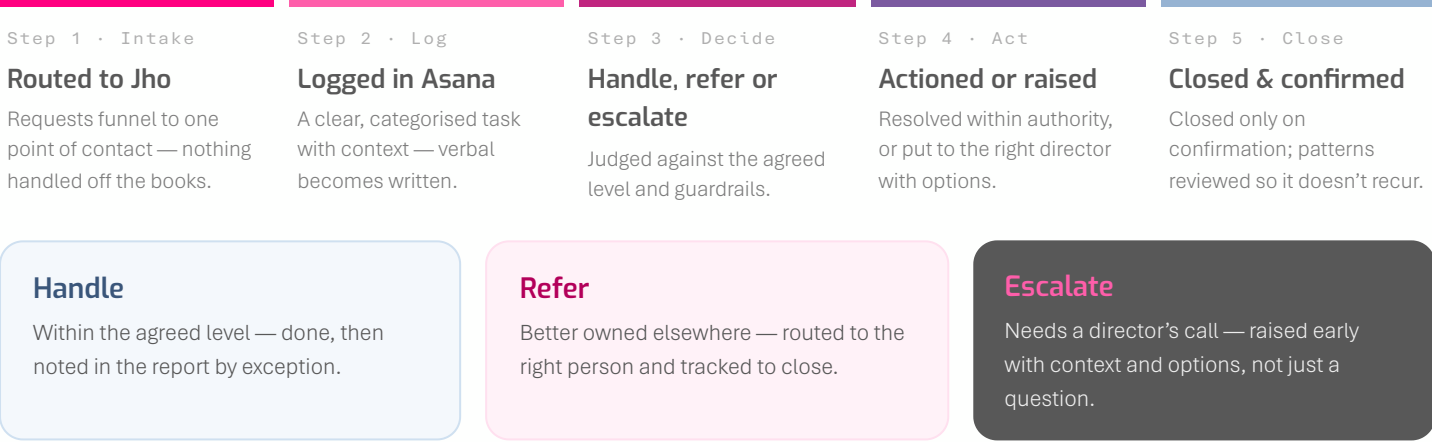
Log once, track to close

Requests are captured once in Asana, tracked until closed, and reviewed for patterns. Nothing lives only in memory or an inbox.

Anticipate, don’t react

Look ahead and remove problems before they land. The best work is the friction the directors never feel in the first place.

HOW A REQUEST MOVES



Daily, weekly & monthly rhythm

The role runs to a known shape: clear risk early, lock the day once, protect focus, and close cleanly — with the week and month layered on top.

THE DAY

Start of day	Scan both directors’ inboxes and calendars; flag anything urgent. Prepare a short morning brief of the day ahead for each.
Morning	Clear the inbox to plan; action and log requests in Asana; confirm the day’s meetings, prep and travel. Protect focus blocks.
Through the day	Filter what reaches the directors; run meeting prep and follow-ups; handle correspondence in their voice; keep tasks moving to close.
End of day	Tidy the queue, roll open items forward visibly, and prepare tomorrow’s look-ahead so the day closes without loose ends.

THE WEEK

Mon	Plan the week; confirm meetings, travel and priorities ahead.
Tue–Thu	Execute — meetings, follow-ups, projects, research and correspondence.
Fri	Close out, reconcile, and prepare next week’s look-ahead for each director.

THE MONTH

01	Reconcile expenses in Dext; close the month’s spend.
02	Look ahead a month — travel, events, deadlines and key dates.
03	Refresh stakeholder, gifting and wellbeing touches due.
04	Review what recurred and refine systems for next month.

Reporting & cadence

Reporting is light, factual and by exception — it exists to keep the directors informed without taking their time. The default is silence on what’s handled and a clear flag on what isn’t.

CADENCE	REPORT	PURPOSE
Daily	Morning brief & day-end note	The day ahead for each director; anything needing their input flagged.
Weekly	Look-ahead & exceptions	Next week’s shape, open items, decisions awaited, things worth knowing.
Monthly	Expenses & commitments	Reconciled spend (Dext), upcoming travel and events, recurring issues.
Ad hoc	Immediate escalation	Anything urgent, sensitive or beyond authority — raised the moment it lands.

REPORT BY EXCEPTION

Don’t narrate everything done — that just adds to the load. Surface what changed, what’s at risk, and what needs a decision. Confidence comes from things quietly working.

TAILORED PER DIRECTOR

Tony and Alexis may want different formats, depth and timing. Learn each one’s preference and report to it — never blur their two pictures into one.

Non-negotiable rules & outcome

- 1** All Director personal data is highly sensitive — never disclosed, even to those claiming a right to know. Unauthorised disclosure is Serious Misconduct.
- 2** Communication, professionalism and presentation are exemplary at all times — *Always Be Kind* in every exchange.
- 3** Asana is the only work register — if it isn't logged, it isn't actioned. Outlook is the only calendar authority.
- 4** The role acts within its agreed trust level — never committing in a director's name beyond it without approval.
- 5** Spend follows the Procurement Policy and the directors' limits; expenses are captured in Dext, never improvised.
- 6** Where the two directors' needs compete, the clash is surfaced — never resolved silently in favour of one.

OPERATING OUTCOME

This playbook exists to create calm.

When it is followed, the role becomes predictable. Predictability builds trust, and trust is what lets the role grow — from reliable hands to a genuine extension of the directors. Structure is what lets us be kind under pressure, and calm systems make room for it.

02

Duty statement & work categories

What the role owns, day to day — its purpose, the decisions it may make, and when to escalate — followed by eighteen work categories, each with a task ladder from reliable hands to full trust.

2.1 Executive Assistant — duty statement

2.2–2.10 Time, comms, operations & events

2.11–2.14 Coordination, knowledge, procurement & personal support

2.15–2.19 Wellbeing, gifting, errands, clients & facilities



Executive Assistant

Jho · the trusted partner to the directors

REPORTING LINE

Both directors — Tony & Alexis

PATTERN

Full-time · Mon–Fri

OPERATING LEVEL

Gatekeeper (Level 3)

The Executive Assistant is the single, trusted interface between the directors and the demands on their time. The role protects their attention, carries their intent into rooms and exchanges, and keeps the office running — filtering what reaches them, anticipating what’s coming, and handling the rest reliably and discreetly. It represents the directors; it does not replace their judgement on matters reserved to them.

WHAT GREAT LOOKS LIKE

Nothing falls through the cracks and nothing reaches the directors that didn’t need to. Their days run smoothly without them assembling them; they feel ahead of their commitments, not behind; and everything sensitive is held in absolute confidence. The office simply works — quietly, kindly and well.

OVERALL ACCOUNTABILITIES

- Time & calendar control
- Inbox & correspondence
- Travel & logistics
- Expenses & spend
- Meetings & follow-up
- Projects & operations
- Research & briefings
- Stakeholders & clients
- Events & hospitality
- Knowledge & information
- Personal director support
- Confidentiality & discretion

Core responsibilities, authority & standards

Protect & steward time

Own both calendars, filter requests, and keep each director ahead of their commitments. **Great:** the plan holds and surprises are rare.

Be the trusted voice

Handle correspondence and front-line contact in each director's voice. **Great:** people feel well looked after; only what matters reaches them.

Run the operation

Drive meetings, follow-ups, projects, travel and events to close in Asana. **Great:** commitments turn into delivery without chasing.

Hold confidence

Protect all sensitive and personal director information absolutely. **Great:** nothing leaks, ever — trust is total.

JHO MAY

Access both directors' calendars, inboxes & systems
Filter, decline and defer on their behalf, kindly
Speak for the office in day-to-day matters
Commit routine time & spend within agreed limits
Engage routine suppliers per the Procurement Policy

JHO MAY NOT

Disclose any personal director information
Commit in a director's name beyond the agreed level
Approve spend above delegated limits
Make decisions reserved to the directors
Resolve a clash between the two of them alone

PERFORMANCE IS MEASURED BY

Control, foresight and discretion — smooth days the directors didn't have to assemble, low last-minute escalation, clean Asana records, accurate spend, and total confidentiality. Confidence, not activity, is the measure.

NON-NEGOTIABLE

Confidentiality is absolute · conduct is exemplary ·
Asana is the work register · the role acts within its trust level · *Always Be Kind.*

Calendaring & meeting management

Where the role’s value first becomes visible — from keeping the diary tidy to stewarding each director’s time as a strategic asset.

WHAT GREAT LOOKS LIKE · AT DELEGATED AUTHORITY

Runs both directors’ calendars autonomously to agreed principles — committing time to their strategic priorities, deciding between competing high-value requests, prioritising client and prospective-client meetings, and protecting their focus without needing to ask.

- Own both Outlook calendars and keep them accurate in real time
- Triage every meeting request — decline, defer or delegate kindly
- Protect daily focus blocks and buffer travel & prep time
- Prioritise client & prospective-client meetings
- Reprioritise around disruption, illness or client need

- 1

Reliable hands
Maintain calendars · send invites & chase RSVPs · confirm appointments · add dial-ins & locations · set up rooms
- 2

Standing access
Own the calendar in real time · protect focus blocks & decline conflicts · build in adequate travel & prep time · run the full meeting cycle
- 3

Gatekeeper
Single point of contact for requests · prioritise client & prospective-client meetings · request agendas in advance · handle running-late & reschedule messages · theme the week · brief each morning
- 4

Delegated authority
Run both calendars autonomously to agreed principles · commit time to strategic priorities · decide between competing high-value requests
- 5

Full trust
Own their time as a strategic asset · commit them without checking first · design the annual rhythm of work, travel and renewal

CURRENT

Email management

Few things drain a leader faster than the inbox. Trust grows from sorting and flagging, to replying, to becoming each director's trusted voice in every exchange.

WHAT GREAT LOOKS LIKE · AT GATEKEEPER

First line for all incoming mail in Outlook — replying to what doesn't need the directors, filtering so only what matters lands, and representing each of them warmly and correctly in writing.

- Monitor and triage both inboxes; surface only what needs them
- Draft considered responses to substantive mail for sign-off
- Track commitments made by email through to action
- Reply to routine & scheduling mail in each director's voice
- Manage persistent or difficult senders diplomatically
- Hold and run the inbox during travel and leave

1 Reliable hands

Monitor & flag urgent mail · sort & label into folders · unsubscribe clutter · draft simple replies for review · capture action items

2 Standing access

Inbox to zero to an agreed system · reply to routine queries · draft in their voice · handle scheduling mail end to end · morning mail summary

3 Gatekeeper

CURRENT

First line for all incoming mail · respond to anything that doesn't need them · prioritise so only what matters reaches them · represent them warmly · manage persistent senders diplomatically · run mail during travel & leave

4 Delegated authority

Manage all mail to agreed principles · reply on substantive matters within guardrails · handle confidential matters discreetly · manage escalations on their behalf

5 Full trust

Be their trusted voice in all written communication · decide entirely what they see · hold every confidence absolutely · carry their intent so faithfully no one can tell the difference

Travel management

Logistics under pressure, often at short notice — for the directors, clients and occasionally managers, covering visas, flights, accommodation, activities and travel expenses. Trust grows from booking what they choose, to designing how each director moves through the world.

WHAT GREAT LOOKS LIKE · AT DELEGATED AUTHORITY

Runs the travel programme autonomously within budget — committing to bookings and changes on their behalf, coordinating confidential or sensitive travel, and resolving crises in transit with delegated authority.

- Plan & book complete trips to standing preferences
- Arrange visas, insurance & health requirements ahead
- Coordinate travel for clients and, occasionally, managers
- Build one reliable mobile itinerary per trip
- Liaise with airlines, hotels & hosts; rebook on disruption
- Track & reconcile travel spend against budget

1 Reliable hands

Research options to choose from · book once approved · build a day-by-day itinerary · arrange transfers · check passport & visa validity

2 Standing access

Book complete trips to standing preferences · respect energy & downtime · manage loyalty programmes · one reliable mobile itinerary · track against budget

3 Gatekeeper

Own travel end to end & present a finished plan · rebook & reroute instantly on disruption · liaise with airlines, hotels & hosts · brief on each destination · on call to fix anything in transit

4 Delegated authority

Run the travel programme autonomously within budget · commit to bookings & changes · coordinate confidential or sensitive travel · resolve crises in transit

CURRENT

5 Full trust

Steward travel as part of their strategy & wellbeing · commit them to any arrangement without checking · design how they move through the world across the year

Expense management

Money work demands accuracy and discretion in equal measure. Captured in Dext and reconciled with Finance — trust climbs from filing receipts, to owning the expense process, to handling sensitive financial matters.

WHAT GREAT LOOKS LIKE · AT GATEKEEPER

Works with Finance to track and lodge all outstanding receipts from the directors, and manages minor expenditures directly — both personal and professional — on their behalf, all within the Procurement Policy and delegated limits.

- Capture all receipts & invoices in Dext, coded & reconciled
- Make & track minor personal and professional purchases
- Prepare the monthly spend summary
- Chase and lodge outstanding director receipts with Finance
- Reconcile corporate cards; flag any discrepancy
- Pre-empt budget overruns before they happen

1 Reliable hands

Collect & file receipts in Dext · prepare expense claims for approval · reconcile card statements · flag bills due · keep records tidy for tax time

2 Standing access

Manage the expense process end to end · reconcile & flag discrepancies · track budget vs actuals · liaise with Finance · prepare monthly spend reports

3 Gatekeeper

CURRENT

Track & lodge outstanding receipts with Finance · manage minor personal & professional expenditures directly · pre-empt budget overruns · handle confidential financial information discreetly

4 Delegated authority

Manage finances within full delegated limits · approve significant spend within authority · handle sensitive financial matters · authorise payments within authority

5 Full trust

Steward financial affairs with fiduciary care · authorise significant payments in their name · coordinate advisers · protect their financial interests at every turn

Social media management

Each director's presence shapes their reputation. The role tends it — from scheduling posts, to becoming the trusted steward of their public voice.

WHAT GREAT LOOKS LIKE · AT GATEKEEPER

Monitors the directors' accounts and works with them to publish well-aligned content **once a week**, true to each personal brand — growing their presence thoughtfully and handling interactions with care.

- Monitor both directors' accounts and engagement
- For Tony: 2 hrs/week LinkedIn outreach & introductions
- Keep presence consistent and on-brand
- Draft & publish ~weekly content aligned to each brand
- Engage their network and reply to comments in voice
- Flag sensitive interactions for the director

FOR TONY

2 hours per week on director outreach via LinkedIn — building his valuable connections and, after a weekly review with him, arranging introductory personal meetings where relevant.

1 Reliable hands

Maintain profiles · schedule & post approved content · monitor mentions · keep bios current · respond to routine comments

2 Standing access

Manage presence day to day · draft posts in their voice · build a content calendar · engage their network · keep the brand consistent

3 Gatekeeper

Publish weekly content aligned to each personal brand · shape voice & presence · draft thought-leadership for review · decide what to post, engage with or ignore · handle sensitive interactions with care

CURRENT

4 Delegated authority

Manage the personal brand with delegated authority · publish & engage in their name · shape public narrative · manage reputation issues proactively

5 Full trust

Be the trusted steward of their public voice · speak as them online with full authority · shape how the world sees them · protect reputation across every platform

Stakeholder management

Relationships are the directors' real currency. The role tends them with care — from keeping contacts tidy, to nurturing connections, to becoming the trusted face of their office.

WHAT GREAT LOOKS LIKE · AT DELEGATED AUTHORITY

Manages relationships with delegated authority — representing their interests to senior stakeholders, smoothing relationships in their name, deciding who gets access and when, and repairing and protecting relationships proactively.

- Maintain an organised, searchable contacts record
- Decide which relationships need investment
- Prepare relationship briefs before meetings
- Keep key relationships warm with timely touches
- Coordinate senior introductions and connections
- Brief each director on who matters and the ask

1 Reliable hands

Maintain an organised contacts database · log interactions & details · send greetings & thanks · track birthdays & milestones · note preferences

2 Standing access

Manage relationships actively · keep key contacts warm with timely touches · coordinate introductions · prepare relationship briefs · flag who needs attention

3 Gatekeeper

Steward key relationships on their behalf · represent them warmly to the network · decide which need investment · coordinate senior introductions · brief on who matters and why

4 Delegated authority

Manage relationships with delegated authority · represent their interests to senior stakeholders · smooth relationships in their name · decide who gets access, and when

CURRENT

5 Full trust

Be the trusted steward of their whole network · represent them to anyone, at any level · steward their reputation as if it were your own · protect the people who matter most

Project management

Behind every effective director is an operation that simply works. The role keeps the machine running — from to-do lists, to owning whole programmes.

WHAT GREAT LOOKS LIKE · AT GATEKEEPER

Manages minor projects on the directors' behalf and reports by exception, and participates as a reliable team member in major projects — for example the company Christmas function — holding contributors accountable for delivery.

- Run minor projects end to end; report by exception
- Sit on major project teams (e.g. the Christmas function)
- Spot & remove small inefficiencies
- Maintain plans, milestones & trackers in Asana
- Chase contributors until items are closed
- Keep project files and status current

1 Reliable hands

Maintain task & to-do lists · track deadlines & flag what's due · keep project files organised · format & proofread · maintain simple trackers

2 Standing access

Coordinate small projects start to finish · keep plans & milestones current · chase contributors · prepare status reports · spot & remove small inefficiencies

3 Gatekeeper

CURRENT

Run minor projects & report by exception · participate in major projects as a team member (e.g. Christmas function) · hold contributors accountable · streamline workflows · own the detail so they hold the big picture

4 Delegated authority

Run operations with real autonomy · make operational decisions within guardrails · commit to contracts within authority · drive initiatives in their name

5 Full trust

Be the operational mind behind everything they do · make significant operational decisions for them · steward delivery across the board · the single point of trust for how things get done

Research & briefings

The directors run on good information delivered at the right moment. Trust grows from gathering facts, to decision-ready briefs, to becoming the intelligence behind their judgement.

WHAT GREAT LOOKS LIKE · AT DELEGATED AUTHORITY

Runs research with real autonomy — forming views and making recommendations the directors can trust, handling confidential research, and profiling counterparts ahead of negotiations. (AI tools assist; no sensitive data is entered — see 1.6.)

- Produce decision-ready briefs with a recommendation
- Monitor news and trends relevant to each director
- Synthesise complex material into clear judgements
- Build profiles of people & organisations before meetings
- Anticipate what they'll need to know and prepare it
- Curate their information diet to cut the noise

1 Reliable hands

Gather information asked for · compile background on people they're meeting · summarise articles · fact-check details · build simple one-page profiles

2 Standing access

Research topics in depth & summarise clearly · prepare briefing notes before meetings · build profiles of people & organisations · monitor relevant news & trends

3 Gatekeeper

Own research & brief by exception · produce decision-ready briefs with recommendations · anticipate what they'll need · profile stakeholders with insight · curate the information diet

4 Delegated authority

Run research with real autonomy · form views & make recommendations they can trust · handle confidential research · profile counterparts ahead of negotiations

CURRENT

5 Full trust

Be the trusted intelligence behind their decisions · advise at the level of a trusted counsellor · anticipate what they'll need before they do · protect them from blind spots

Event management

From a quiet dinner to a flagship gathering, how the directors host shapes how they're seen. The role **leads small events and supports larger ones**, depending on size.

WHAT GREAT LOOKS LIKE · AT GATEKEEPER

Owens small events end to end and reports by exception — deciding format, venue and guest list to brief, negotiating with suppliers, pre-empting problems on the day — and supports the team on larger events under their lead.

- Own small events end to end; support larger ones
- Negotiate with venues, caterers & suppliers
- Manage event budgets and last-minute changes
- Decide format, venue and guest list to brief
- Build run-sheets; manage RSVPs & dietaries
- Pre-empt and solve problems on the day

1 Reliable hands

Book restaurants & tables · send & track invitations · order catering · manage RSVPs & headcounts · coordinate dietary requirements

2 Standing access

Plan & run small events end to end · manage guest lists · coordinate venues, catering & suppliers · build run-sheets · manage budgets & last-minute changes

3 Gatekeeper

CURRENT

Own small events end to end & report by exception · support larger events under direction · negotiate with venues & suppliers · curate guest lists with judgement · pre-empt problems on the day

4 Delegated authority

Run events with delegated authority · commit to venues, budgets & suppliers · host & represent them when they can't attend · approve event spend within authority

5 Full trust

Be the trusted host & steward of every occasion · plan & commit to events in their name · curate the most sensitive gatherings · protect their privacy & image at every event

Internal coordination & liaison

The team is the directors' multiplier. The role keeps the office and team connected — from coordinating logistics, to being the trusted point of contact across the business.

WHAT GREAT LOOKS LIKE · AT GATEKEEPER

The trusted point of contact between the directors and the team — coordinating across the business, pre-empting issues, handling sensitive matters discreetly, and briefing the directors only on what needs a decision.

- Be the trusted contact between directors and team
- Pre-empt issues; handle sensitive matters discreetly
- Keep the office connected across the business
- Coordinate logistics, onboarding & team events
- Relay decisions accurately; chase actions to close
- Brief directors only on what needs a decision

1 Reliable hands

Maintain team contact & org details · help onboard joiners with logistics · coordinate team events · track key dates · relay messages accurately

2 Standing access

Coordinate across teams day to day · support the team's needs · keep things running smoothly between the directors and the business · track timelines

3 Gatekeeper

CURRENT

Trusted point of contact for the team · coordinate across the business on their behalf · pre-empt issues · handle sensitive matters discreetly · brief only on what needs a decision

4 Delegated authority

Coordinate with delegated authority · handle confidential people matters · represent the directors to the team on routine matters · coordinate sensitive conversations

5 Full trust

Be the trusted custodian of internal matters · represent the directors to the team with full trust · steward the team's experience & culture on their behalf

Knowledge & information management

The directors' memory shouldn't live only in their heads. The role builds the systems that keep everything findable — and becomes the trusted keeper of what they know.

WHAT GREAT LOOKS LIKE · AT GATEKEEPER

Owens the information architecture on their behalf — deciding what to keep, archive and discard, maintaining confidential records discreetly, surfacing the right information at the right moment, and keeping institutional memory so nothing is lost.

- Own the filing & information architecture
- Decide what to keep, archive and discard
- Surface the right information at the right moment
- Make anything findable in seconds
- Maintain confidential records securely
- Keep institutional memory between people

1 Reliable hands

Organise files & folders logically · maintain clear naming conventions · file so anything is found in seconds · back up records · tag & sort incoming information

2 Standing access

Design & run the filing & knowledge systems · maintain a knowledge base on priorities · capture meeting notes · manage retention · build quick-reference guides

3 Gatekeeper

CURRENT

Own the information architecture · decide what to keep, archive & discard · maintain confidential records discreetly · surface the right information at the right moment · keep institutional memory

4 Delegated authority

Manage knowledge systems with delegated authority · handle confidential records securely · decide access & permissions in their name · steward data governance & retention

5 Full trust

Be the trusted keeper of everything they know · steward information as a strategic asset · hold their most confidential records absolutely · be the single source of truth they rely on

Minor procurement

Getting the right things at the right price, reliably — **in line with the company Procurement Policy**. The role handles minor procurement; anything beyond it is escalated.

WHAT GREAT LOOKS LIKE · AT GATEKEEPER

Owens minor procurement on the directors' behalf within Procurement Policy limits — deciding what to source and from whom, negotiating routine terms, pre-empting supply problems, and stewarding quality and value across suppliers.

- Source, compare & order within Policy limits
- Manage day-to-day vendor relationships
- Steward quality & value; pre-empt supply problems
- Negotiate routine terms with suppliers
- Reconcile orders against budget; keep records
- Escalate anything above the minor threshold

1 Reliable hands

Source & compare suppliers & quotes · place orders & track deliveries · maintain a vendor directory · process supplier paperwork · keep records in order

2 Standing access

Manage routine procurement end to end · negotiate basic terms · manage vendor relationships · reconcile orders against budget · onboard & vet new suppliers

3 Gatekeeper

CURRENT

Own minor procurement within Policy limits · negotiate routine terms · decide what to source and from whom · pre-empt supply problems · steward quality & value — escalate anything above the threshold

4 Delegated authority

Manage procurement with delegated authority · negotiate & commit to contracts in their name · approve spend within authority · manage strategic supplier relationships

5 Full trust

Be the trusted steward of procurement · negotiate & commit on significant contracts · hold confidential commercial information absolutely · protect their commercial interests

Personal director support

The best support doesn’t stop at the office door. Where invited, the role gives each director their life back — from errands and appointments, to running their personal world so they’re free to focus. Held with particular discretion.

WHAT GREAT LOOKS LIKE · AT DELEGATED AUTHORITY

- Manages each director’s personal affairs with delegated authority — making personal decisions within agreed guardrails, handling highly sensitive matters discreetly, and coordinating their whole life as one trusted whole.
- Run personal admin and the personal calendar
 - Handle sensitive personal matters with discretion
 - Coordinate deliveries, returns & bookings
 - Coordinate household appointments & services
 - Anticipate and pre-empt needs before asked
 - Protect personal time and space fiercely

FOR TONY

Also manages Tony’s personal investment properties — coordinating tenants, agents, maintenance and routine paperwork — and keeps his personal vehicle licensing, registration and servicing current so nothing ever lapses.

- 1

Reliable hands
Book personal appointments · order household essentials · arrange deliveries & returns · manage a personal to-do list · book personal travel & outings
- 2

Standing access
Manage personal admin end to end · coordinate household appointments & services · manage the personal calendar alongside work · anticipate needs before asked
- 3

Gatekeeper
Run the personal side on their behalf · manage personal priorities · handle sensitive personal matters discreetly · anticipate & pre-empt needs · protect their personal time and space
- 4

Delegated authority
Manage personal affairs with delegated authority · make personal decisions within guardrails · handle highly sensitive matters discreetly · coordinate their whole life as one
- 5

Full trust
Steward their personal life as a trusted equal · hold their deepest confidences absolutely · protect their privacy, time & wellbeing fiercely · free them to live, knowing it’s handled

CURRENT

Health & wellbeing

The directors’ performance rests on their wellbeing. The role protects it — from booking appointments, to guarding their health as carefully as their work. Health information is highly sensitive (see 1.6).

WHAT GREAT LOOKS LIKE · AT STANDING ACCESS

Manages each director’s health appointments end to end — coordinating fitness and self-care routines, liaising with providers, planning downtime and recovery into the week, and anticipating wellbeing needs before they’re voiced.

- Coordinate care & appointments across providers
- Track reminders, prescriptions & renewals
- Plan downtime & recovery into the week
- Protect diary time for rest and exercise
- Handle sensitive health matters discreetly
- Keep wellbeing a standing, quiet priority

1 Reliable hands

Book medical, dental & wellness appointments · track reminders · order prescriptions · coordinate fitness bookings · keep routines on the calendar

2 Standing access

CURRENT

Manage health appointments end to end · coordinate fitness & self-care routines · liaise with providers · plan downtime & recovery into the week · anticipate needs

3 Gatekeeper

Steward wellbeing on their behalf · coordinate care across providers · protect time for rest & exercise · handle sensitive health matters discreetly · keep wellbeing a quiet priority

4 Delegated authority

Manage wellbeing with delegated authority · coordinate sensitive medical matters discreetly · liaise with specialists in their name · protect health against the schedule

5 Full trust

Be the trusted guardian of their health & wellbeing · hold their most sensitive health confidences · protect their wellbeing as fiercely as their work · anticipate everything it needs

Gifting & gestures

Thoughtfulness, remembered. The role keeps the directors' generosity consistent — from ordering flowers, to giving exactly as they would. A natural expression of *Always Be Kind*.

WHAT GREAT LOOKS LIKE · AT DELEGATED AUTHORITY

Manages gifting with delegated authority — committing to significant gifts on the directors' behalf, curating gestures for key relationships in their name, and handling confidential and sensitive gifting with discretion.

- Maintain the gifting calendar, preferences & budget
- Manage corporate, client & VIP gifting
- Plan seasonal and holiday gifting ahead
- Choose gifts that reflect each relationship
- Arrange wrapping, delivery & a timely thank-you
- Keep their thoughtfulness consistent and never late

1 Reliable hands

Order gifts, cards & flowers on request · track birthdays & occasions · maintain a gift list & budget · arrange delivery & presentation · record gifts given

2 Standing access

Manage the gifting calendar end to end · source thoughtful gifts for any occasion · coordinate corporate & client gifting · maintain preferences · anticipate occasions

3 Gatekeeper

Steward gifting on their behalf · choose gifts that reflect each relationship · decide what's appropriate for whom · manage VIP & client gifting · keep thoughtfulness consistent

4 Delegated authority

Manage gifting with delegated authority · commit to significant gifts · curate gestures for key relationships in their name · handle confidential & sensitive gifting

CURRENT

5 Full trust

Be the trusted steward of their generosity · make significant gifting decisions in their name · strengthen relationships through thoughtfulness · give as they would

Errands & day-to-day

The small things that quietly eat a week. The role clears them — from a single pick-up, to running the directors' day-to-day so the trivial never reaches them.

WHAT GREAT LOOKS LIKE · AT GATEKEEPER

Owens day-to-day logistics on the directors' behalf — deciding and prioritising what gets done, coordinating a network of trusted services, pre-empting the errands they'd forget, and keeping their daily life frictionless.

- Own day-to-day logistics; decide what gets done
- Pre-empt recurring errands they'd forget
- Manage recurring supplies and reorders
- Coordinate trusted local services & couriers
- Handle sensitive errands discreetly
- Keep the trivial away from the directors

1 Reliable hands

Run errands & pick-ups as needed · arrange deliveries, collections & returns · handle post & courier needs · restock everyday essentials · keep a running errand list

2 Standing access

Manage errands end to end · coordinate couriers & delivery services · anticipate routine errands before asked · manage recurring supplies · keep small things from piling up

3 Gatekeeper

CURRENT

Own day-to-day logistics on their behalf · decide & prioritise what gets done · coordinate a network of trusted services · pre-empt the errands they'd forget · keep daily life frictionless

4 Delegated authority

Manage daily logistics with delegated authority · commit to services & spend on their behalf · coordinate sensitive errands discreetly · manage trusted local relationships in their name

5 Full trust

Be the trusted hand behind their daily life · run their day-to-day entirely · handle the sensitive and the mundane alike · protect their time from the trivial absolutely

Client liaison

Clients meet Brainbox through this role as much as through the directors. How they're looked after shapes the relationship — from arranging the logistics, to being a trusted, warm point of contact for the directors' clients.

WHAT GREAT LOOKS LIKE · AT GATEKEEPER

A warm, reliable point of contact for clients on the directors' behalf — representing them with care, coordinating client meetings and hospitality, handling sensitive client matters discreetly, and making sure every client feels expected and well looked after.

- Be a warm, reliable contact for the directors' clients
- Handle routine client correspondence in voice
- Make every client feel expected
- Coordinate client meetings, visits & hospitality
- Keep client records warm and current
- Flag sensitive client matters to the director

1 Reliable hands

Schedule client meetings & calls · send confirmations & reminders · log client details & preferences · arrange hospitality & meeting logistics · relay messages accurately

2 Standing access

Handle routine client correspondence in their voice · coordinate client visits & stays · keep client records warm & current · prepare client briefs before meetings

3 Gatekeeper

CURRENT

Be a warm, trusted point of contact for clients · represent the directors with care · coordinate client meetings & hospitality · handle sensitive client matters discreetly · make every client feel expected

4 Delegated authority

Manage client relationships with delegated authority · represent the directors' interests to clients · handle sensitive client matters · smooth & repair relationships in their name

5 Full trust

Be the trusted face of the directors' office to clients · represent them to any client at any level · hold every client confidence absolutely · protect the relationships that matter most

Facilities support

Alongside the Executive Assistant role, Jho holds a **minor, part-time** role as Facilities Assistant. This is a supporting function carried out **under the direction of the Fleet & Facilities Manager** — it is not directed from this playbook.

THE AUTHORITY FOR THIS PART OF THE ROLE

See the Fleet & Facilities Playbook — Duty Statement 2.2, Facilities Assistant (part-time).

That document defines the duties, decision rights, effort cap and escalation for the facilities role in full. Where the two playbooks ever differ on facilities work, the Fleet & Facilities Playbook wins.

IN SHORT, THE FACILITIES ROLE

Is the single intake point for facilities requests, coordinates the Asana queue under the Manager’s direction, monitors Uplisting and prepares reporting — logging and ordering work, never prioritising or approving it alone.

HOW IT SITS WITH THIS ROLE

Effort is capped and protected so it never crowds out the Executive Assistant duties. When the two compete, the clash is surfaced to the directors and the Facilities Manager — not resolved silently.

03

Checklists

Print, tick and sign. These are the working checklists behind the rhythms in part one — carried out day to day, then logged in Asana.

Daily operating checklist

Clear risk early, lock the day, protect focus, close cleanly. Everything actioned is logged in Asana with detail, a due date, status and next step.

START OF DAY

- ☐ Scan both directors' inboxes; flag anything urgent
- ☐ Review both calendars; confirm the day's meetings
- ☐ Check agendas & prep are ready for each meeting
- ☐ Review the Asana queue; reprioritise for today

END OF DAY

- ☐ Update Asana statuses & next steps
- ☐ Roll open items forward visibly
- ☐ Prepare tomorrow's look-ahead
- ☐ Flag anything for a director's decision
- ☐ Secure sensitive documents; clear desk & lock screen

THROUGH THE DAY

- ☐ Triage inboxes; reply to what doesn't need them
- ☐ Convert every new request into an Asana task
- ☐ Handle running-late & reschedule messages
- ☐ Take meeting notes; capture actions & owners
- ☐ Keep tasks moving; chase what's due

ALWAYS

- ☐ Communication exemplary; *Always Be Kind*
- ☐ Nothing actioned that isn't logged in Asana
- ☐ Confidentiality absolute; escalate if unsure

DATE _____

INITIALS

NOTES

Meeting preparation & follow-up

A meeting is only as good as what happens after it. Turn conversations into commitments, and commitments into delivery — all tracked in Asana.

BEFORE

- ☐ Confirm purpose, attendees and the right slot
- ☐ Prepare a briefing pack & profiles of attendees
- ☐ Send reminders; reconfirm the day before
- ☐ Request or draft an agenda; circulate ahead
- ☐ Confirm room/link, tech and any catering
- ☐ Prepare talking points or questions

DURING

- ☐ Take clear, accurate notes
- ☐ Note decisions and any commitments made
- ☐ Capture every action, owner and due date
- ☐ Hold sensitive content in confidence

AFTER

- ☐ Distribute notes promptly
- ☐ Chase action owners until items close
- ☐ Log every action in Asana with owner & date
- ☐ Summarise outcomes for those who missed it

MEETING

DATE

INITIALS

Travel booking & itinerary

For the directors, clients and occasionally managers. Work it through in order so nothing is missed and the traveller has one reliable plan.

PLAN & APPROVE

- ☐ Confirm purpose, dates & who is travelling
- ☐ Check passport/visa validity well ahead
- ☐ Research options against preferences & budget
- ☐ Confirm the plan / get approval as needed

PRE-DEPARTURE

- ☐ Build one day-by-day mobile itinerary
- ☐ Brief on destination logistics & etiquette
- ☐ Reconfirm all bookings 24–48 hrs before

BOOK

- ☐ Book flights, accommodation & transfers
- ☐ Apply seat, room & meal preferences; loyalty
- ☐ Arrange insurance & any health requirements
- ☐ Capture all costs in Dext against the trip

IN TRANSIT & AFTER

- ☐ Be on call; rebook & reroute on disruption
- ☐ Keep the itinerary updated in real time
- ☐ Reconcile travel spend on return

TRAVELLER & TRIP

DATES

INITIALS

Weekly close & look-ahead

End each week deliberately so the next one starts clean. Close out, reconcile, and prepare a clear picture for each director.

CLOSE THE WEEK

- ☐ Review the Asana queue; close completed tasks
- ☐ Chase stale or unclear items; update statuses
- ☐ Reconcile the week’s expenses in Dext
- ☐ Note recurring issues & trends to refine

REPORT

- ☐ Prepare the weekly look-ahead & exceptions note
- ☐ List decisions awaited from each director
- ☐ For Tony: confirm LinkedIn outreach & intros

LOOK AHEAD

- ☐ Build next week’s shape for each director
- ☐ Confirm meetings, prep, travel & deadlines
- ☐ Surface clashes between the two directors early
- ☐ Check stakeholder, gifting & wellbeing touches due

TIDY & SECURE

- ☐ File & archive the week’s documents correctly
- ☐ Confirm sensitive material is stored securely
- ☐ Update contacts & records touched this week

WEEK ENDING

INITIALS

NOTES

04

Reference

The standards that keep it all consistent — what great looks like, how Asana is kept, how things escalate, and how this document is controlled.

-
- 4.1 Service standards
 - 4.2 Asana conventions
 - 4.3 Escalation matrix

- 4.4 Trust levels in full
- 4.5 Reporting lines & boundaries
- 4.6 Document control

Service standards — what great looks like

These qualitative standards apply across every work category. They describe how the role should feel to the directors and everyone it touches — not targets to hit, but the bar to hold.

Responsive

Acknowledge promptly, even when the answer takes longer. Urgent and risk items reach the right director at once; nothing important sits unseen.

Anticipatory

The need is met before it's voiced. Problems are removed before the directors feel them; they walk into every room prepared.

Accurate

Details are right the first time — names, times, numbers, bookings. Work is checked before it goes out; the directors can trust it without re-checking.

Discreet

Confidence is absolute and security instinctive. Sensitive matters are handled quietly; nothing is ever shared that shouldn't be (see 1.6).

Polished

Communication, presentation and dress are exemplary. Everything that carries the directors' name is well-made and on-brand.

Kind

Warm and respectful with everyone — directors, colleagues, clients and suppliers. Firm when needed, kind always.
Always Be Kind.

THE SINGLE MEASURE

The directors feel ahead of their commitments, never behind — their days run smoothly without them assembling them, and they never have to wonder whether something was handled. Confidence, not activity, is the measure of the role.

Asana conventions

Asana is the **primary work platform** of the role. All activities are recorded and tracked here — it is what makes the role visible, accountable and safe to hand more to over time.

EVERY TASK CARRIES

Granular detail

Clear description & context — anyone could pick it up

A due date

Realistic, kept current, never blank

Accurate status

Reflects reality at any moment

Next step

What happens next, where relevant

GOOD PRACTICE

- Log verbal requests as tasks before acting
- One task per piece of work — no duplicates
- Attach context, files and photos where useful
- Update status & next step as things move
- Close only on confirmation, not assumption

AVOID

- Work held only in your head or an inbox
- Tasks with no owner, date or detail
- Stale statuses that no longer reflect reality
- Duplicate or vague “catch-all” tasks
- Confidential detail where it shouldn’t sit

If it isn't in Asana, it isn't happening. A task gives every piece of work an owner, a history and a finish line — that's what makes the role accountable rather than just busy.

Escalation matrix

For every request, the question is the same: handle, refer, or escalate? This is the quick guide — when unsure, escalate.

Handle WITHIN LEVEL	WHEN Routine, within the agreed Gatekeeper level and any spend/Procurement limits.	EXAMPLES Scheduling, routine replies, bookings, minor purchases, briefs, standard supplier orders.
Refer RIGHT OWNER	WHEN Better owned by someone else — Finance, Facilities Manager, IT, an adviser.	EXAMPLES Facilities work (to the F&F Manager), payroll/finance queries, IT issues, legal questions.
Escalate DIRECTOR'S CALL	WHEN Beyond the agreed level, sensitive, above spend limits, or a clash between the two directors.	EXAMPLES Disclosure requests, significant spend, commitments in a director's name, anything you're unsure of.
HOW TO ESCALATE WELL Raise it early, to the right director, with context and options — not just a question. For anything touching confidentiality, the default is to say nothing and ask first.		

Trust levels in full

The role operates at **Gatekeeper (Level 3)** by default. This is the ladder each work category climbs — lift a category by agreement with the directors as the partnership proves itself.

1	Reliable hands	Works from instructions on everyday, low-stakes tasks. Output stays visible; no access to anything sensitive.
2	Standing access	Recurring access to calendar, inbox and systems, applying light judgement to keep the routine moving unprompted.
3	Gatekeeper	Current default. Represents and filters on the director’s behalf — decides what reaches them, speaks for the office day to day, protects their time.
4	Delegated authority	Decides within agreed guardrails and handles sensitive, financial and confidential matters. The directors set the boundaries; the role owns what’s inside.
5	Full trust	Acts on the director’s behalf on confidential, strategic and fiduciary matters — a genuine extension of them, trusted to commit in their name.
1 → 5	From unlocking capacity to extending capability. Begin focused; widen the categories, hand over more, and lift the level as trust grows — until the role is a genuine extension of the directors.	

Reporting lines & boundaries

Because the role straddles so many functions, its reporting line and boundaries need to be unusually clear — and gently protected day to day.

REPORTS TO THE DIRECTORS ONLY

This role reports to the directors — Tony and Alexis — and not to local managers or any other personnel.

Because the role works across so many functions, there is an ever-present risk that local reporting or accountability creeps in. Any attempt to circumvent this line — or to introduce any form of local reporting or local accountability — is **politely referred to the directors**. The role takes direction on tasks from many people; it answers to only two.

— Respect for leadership

Representing the directors' interests does not make this a manager-level role. Take care to engage in every manager-level interaction respectfully and mindful of their leadership positions in the company — influence comes through service and courtesy, never status.

— Friendships & boundaries

The directors encourage workplace friendships — and they're welcome. This role must stay particularly vigilant about actual and perceived boundaries and confidentiality at all times: warmth with colleagues never softens what is held in confidence.

IN SHORT

Take tasks from many; report to two. Be warm with everyone and careful with all. When a line is tested, refer it kindly to the directors rather than resolving it in the moment.

Document control

This is a controlled document and a living one — it will be revised over successive iterations as the role and the trust within it grow.

DOCUMENT	Executive Assistant Playbook
EDITION	Edition 1 · 2026 — first iteration
ROLE HOLDER	Jho — Executive Assistant
OWNERS	The directors — Tony & Alexis
CLASSIFICATION	Internal — controlled document
REVIEW	Reviewed and re-issued by agreement; not edited on the run

CONTROLLED DOCUMENT

This is the authority for how the role is done. Where it differs from habit or memory, the playbook wins. Changes are made deliberately and re-issued, never made on the run.

A LIVING DOCUMENT

Refined each iteration — sharpening duties, lifting trust levels by agreement, and folding in what works. Suggestions are welcome; changes are confirmed by the directors and re-issued.

ALWAYS BE KIND

Structure is what lets us be kind under pressure.

Calm systems make room for it — for the directors, for colleagues and clients, and for the person who holds this role. Keep this playbook close, and let it grow as the trust does.